

Wheeled Troop Carriers (cont.)

Some nations assessed wheeled carriers as being better suited to their requirements than tracked vehicles. This included many African countries, who operated carriers over large areas of relatively smooth terrain. With generally lighter weight and lower ground pressure, wheeled vehicles could often move through areas that their heavier tracked counterparts could not, and rubber tires did less damage to local infrastructure than metal tracks. They also offered higher speeds, better reliability, and more protection against mines.

▷ Véhicule de l'Avant Blindé
Date 1976 Country France
Weight 14.3 tons (13 tonnes)
Engine Renault MIDS 06-20-45 diesel, 220 hp
Main armament .50 Browning M2 machine gun

The Véhicule de l'Avant Blindé (VAB) was intended as a counterpart to the tracked AMX-10P. Featuring amphibious capability and NBC protection, it can carry ten infantrymen. VABs have received hundreds of upgrades and continue in French service today. Its many variants include anti-aircraft-missile launcher, radar carrier, and command-post models.



Windscreen can be covered by shutter

Pneumatic tires

All-welded armored steel

△ Transportpanzer 1 Fuchs
Date 1979 Country West Germany
Weight 20.9 tons (19 tonnes)
Engine Mercedes-Benz OM 402A diesel, 320 hp
Main armament 7.62 mm MG3 machine gun

The basic Fuchs APC carried 10 infantrymen, and variants included radar vehicles, supply carriers, and electronic warfare platforms. The NBC reconnaissance vehicle was the most successful export version, its major buyers being the UK and the US.



Aluminum hull protects against small-arms fire



Rifle ports

△ Ratel 20
Date 1979 Country South Africa
Weight 20.9 tons (19 tonnes)
Engine Bussing D 3256 BXTF diesel, 282 hp
Main armament 20 mm M693 cannon

The arms embargo and the unique conditions facing South African forces during the 1970s and '80s forced them to design their own combat vehicles, using wheeled vehicles for their mobility and range. More heavily armed Ratels equipped with a 90 mm gun provided fire support for the 20 mm-armed vehicle.

△ Blindado Medio de Ruedas (BMR) 600
Date 1979 Country Spain
Weight 15.5 tons (14 tonnes)
Engine Pegaso 9157/8 diesel, 310 hp
Main armament .50 Browning M2 machine gun

The BMR-600 and its many variants have seen service in the Balkans, Lebanon, and Iraq, as well as Afghanistan. It shares components with the VEC M1 armored car and both vehicles have received an upgrade to M1 standard, involving a new engine and additional armor.



25 mm cannon

◁ LAV-25
Date 1983 Country USA
Weight 14.2 tons (12.9 tonnes)
Engine Detroit Diesel 6V53T diesel, 275 hp
Main armament 25 mm M242 cannon

The US Marine Corps version of the MOWAG Piranha I, the LAV-25 is used mainly for reconnaissance. Its variants include anti-tank, command, and recovery vehicles. The fleet has undergone upgrades to armor, suspension, and sights over time, and in response to experiences in the Persian Gulf and Afghanistan.